unless the agriculturists were prosperous and could afford to be mulcted to the extent of 12.5 percent, the 1s 6d rate was to be considered as 'regularized loot on the growers of India.'[10]

Attempt to Deceive

In March 1927, Sir Basil moved a Bill to amend the Indian Coinage Act of 1906 and the Indian Currency Act of 1923, proof that the government proposed to implement the recommendations of the Hilton Young Commission. Battle lines were drawn as both camps tried to muster support for their respective causes. Purshotamdas sought the support of B.F. Madon (who had earlier given outstanding evidence in favour of a 1s 4d ratio before the Commission), Jamnadas M. Mehta, and G.D. Birla to prepare a special memorandum for the benefit of the legislators.

The four men often met at 2 Mansingh Road, Purshotamdas's residence in New Delhi. It was not uncommon for their meetings to continue well into the night. On one such night when Pt Madan Mohan Malaviya was also present, they heard a knock on the door and on opening it found an old bearded man who appeared to be in a highly strung and nervous state. He had a bicycle with him and said that he had been frightened by an animal roaming on the road and had taken refuge in Purshotamdas's compound. An unsuspecting Purshotamdas invited him to come in and lie down on the sofa. The group continued its discussion but Pt Malaviya's suspicions had been aroused and he asked the man to leave. Purshotamdas, who was more trusting, was reluctant to let the man go since he still seemed to be an in overwrought state. Malaviya told Purshotamdas, 'Let him go. His friends are outside.'[11] Malaviya's suspicions were proved right. The man turned out to be a government informer who was seen entering Sir Basil's house early in the morning. He had been given the task of spying on the activities of the group and reporting back to his masters in the government.

But more skullduggery was in store. This incident occurred just before the fate of the Bill was to be decided in the Assembly. Purshotamdas was working in his office room, and G.D. Birla was in an adjoining room when a visitor was announced, requesting a few minutes of Birla's time. Birla spoke to him and then told Purshotamdas that the man had offered six votes in the Assembly if he was paid a sum of ₹6,000. He did not want the money